



## 2026 SCCNH Gravel Trials Rules



Rev 1 12/2025

## Gravel Trial Rules

- 1. Purpose:** Gravel trials are designed to provide affordable seat time to New England's aspiring rally community. The main focus is on learning and gaining experience, more so than being a competition. The Gravel trials will also give new volunteer workers a chance to learn a position and experienced workers will have an opportunity to try new positions.
- 2. Waivers:** All individuals entering the facility, including team members and crew, workers and spectators must sign the required waivers upon entering the property. Anyone under the age of 18 must have a minor waiver completed by parent/guardian.
- 3. SCCNH Membership:** all drivers and co-drivers must be SCCNH members. Membership in SCCNH is for the calendar year, January 1 through December 31. The SCCNH membership can be purchased online through Motorsportreg, direct link is [msreg.com/Membership](https://msreg.com/Membership).
- 4. Competitors age:** Any competitor, whether driver or co-driver, must be 16 years or older. Anyone below the age of 18 must have a minor waiver completed.
  - 4.1 License:** Any person driving in the Gravel trials must possess a valid driver's license from their home state. No other competition license is required.
  - 4.2** Any person driving in the Gravel trials below the age of 18 must have:
    - 4.2.1** Previous experience on non-paved surfaces. As a minimum, 4 rallycross events. A rally driving school class would be acceptable in place of the rallycross criteria.
    - 4.2.2** Approval from the Gravel Trials Chairperson and Safety Steward.
    - 4.2.3** Minor Waiver completed.
- 5. Number of Entrants:** The event will be limited to 30 teams. A team consists of a driver and a co-driver. A team is not officially entered until all required entry forms and materials are submitted and payment in full is received. A "wait list" will be maintained in the case of withdrawals, using the registration date and time to set the order.
- 6. Entry Paperwork:** for an entry to be considered complete, the following must be submitted:
  - Entry fees: submitted on-line through Motorsportreg.com
  - Entry information for driver, co-driver, crew members through Motorsportreg.com
  - Vehicle information: class, number, year, make and model, color, through Motorsportreg.com
  - Drivers must send electronic verification of driver's license to the registrar, or be prepared to show at Tech Inspection.
  - Valid registration for the competition vehicle should be sent to the registrar, or be prepared to show at Tech Inspection.
  - Insurance: current insurance for the competition vehicle should be sent to the registrar, or be prepared to show at Tech Inspection.

**7. Competition Classes:** Adjusted engine capacity is the actual displacement for normally-aspirated engines or 1.4 times the actual displacement for vehicles with forced induction (turbochargers, superchargers). Table 1 summarizes the equivalence between Gravel trials classes and classes of other sanctioning bodies.

| Standard     | SCCNH Gravel Trials | ARA                              | CRC                     | NASA                                          |
|--------------|---------------------|----------------------------------|-------------------------|-----------------------------------------------|
| 2WD <2500cc  | <b>R2U</b>          | Limited 2WD                      | Limited 2WD<br>Open 2WD | Open 2WD light<br>Stock light                 |
| 2WD >=2500cc | <b>R2O</b>          | Open 2WD                         | Open 2WD                | Open 2WD heavy<br>Stock heavy                 |
| 4WD <2500cc  | <b>R4U</b>          | NA 4WD                           | Limited 4WD<br>Open 4WD | Open 4WD light<br>Stock Light                 |
| 4WD >=2500cc | <b>R4O</b>          | NA4WD<br>Limited 4WD<br>Open 4WD | Open 4WD                | Open 4WD heavy<br>Stock Medium<br>Stock Heavy |
| FIA RC2      | <b>Exhibition</b>   | RC2 or Open 4WD                  | Open 4WD                | Pro                                           |
| Factory cars | <b>Exhibition</b>   | Open 4WD                         | Open 4WD                | Super Open /Exhibition                        |

*Table 1. Equivalence between Gravel Trials classes and classes of other sanctioning bodies*

7.1. Two-Wheel Drive Under 2.5 Liters (**R2U**) – for front- or rear-wheel drive vehicles with adjusted engine capacity under 2.5 liters, with driver and co-driver.

7.2. Two-Wheel Drive Over 2.5 Liters (**R2O**) – for front- or rear-wheel drive vehicles with adjusted engine capacity of 2.5 liters or greater, with driver and co-driver.

7.3. Four-Wheel Drive Under 2.5 Liters (**R4U**) – for all- or four-wheel drive vehicles with adjusted engine capacity under 2.5 liters, with driver and co-driver.

7.4. Four-Wheel Drive Over 2.5 Liters (**R4O**) -- for all- or four-wheel drive vehicles with adjusted engine capacity of 2.5 liters or greater, with driver and co-driver.

7.5. Exhibition class – this is a non-competition class for all FIA RC2 vehicles, vehicles running WRC studded tires during winter events or vehicles that do not fit in the current ruleset at the discretion of the organizers.

**7A. Restrictors:** Forced induction engines in 4WD cars must have an air inlet orifice of 36mm diameter or less, either through manufacture or by the use of a restrictor. This restrictor must have a minimum width (parallel to the air flow path) of 3 mm and must be located within 50 mm of the compressor wheel. All air entering the engine must pass through the restrictor. Novices do not have to use smaller restrictors. Competition vehicles not complying with this rule, will not be allowed to compete, no exception.

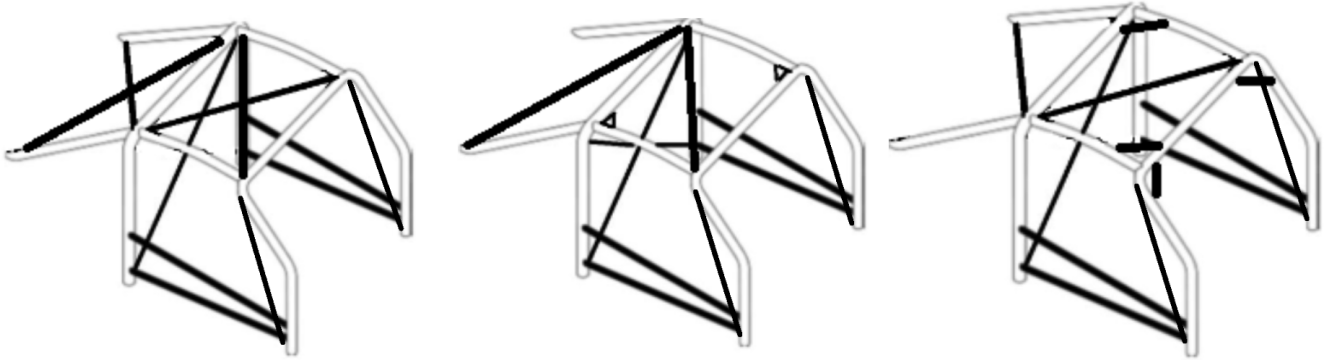
**8. Log Books:** All cars entering this event must be log booked through Rally America, SCCA Pro Rally, CARS, ARA, FIA or NASA Rallysport. If log booked through another organization, you must contact the Chairman for approval.

**8.1 Issuing of Log Book:** Due to the compressed schedule for these events, there will be no inspection session to issue log books.

**9. Required Vehicle Safety Equipment:** The following are the minimum safety requirements for the competition vehicle. It is expected that safety equipment is installed in a manner consistent with manufacturer's intent.

**9.1 Cages:** All cages, regardless of log book must have:

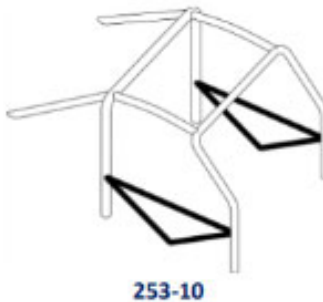
- six-point mounting design
- A-pillar support bars (aka A-Pillar reinforcement, Windscreen Pillar reinforcement)
- two door bars per side minimum
- Diagonals to each corner of the top of the main hoop, whether in the plane of the main hoop or the rear stays. May be single or double diagonals.
- minimum tubing size is 1.5"x0.095"
- Diagrams below show A-pillar supports, roof bar options, single and double diagonal braces, and one style of double door bars.



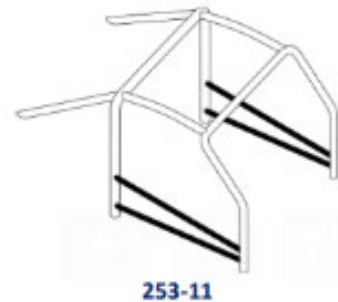
Diagrams below are strictly to show only the acceptable door bar configurations.



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For questions regarding cages, contact the Tech Inspector.

**9.2 Padding:** Any portion of the roll cage which could come into contact with the driver or co-driver's helmet during competition, including all bars in the plane of the roof and forward of the main hoop, shall be covered with energy absorbing material compliant with either the SFI 45.1 specification or FIA Standard 8857-2001 Type A.

**9.3 Seats:** Driver and co-driver seats shall be firmly mounted to the structure of the vehicle and be installed per the manufacturer's recommendations. The use of hinged-back and OEM seats is prohibited. All the occupants' seats must be homologated by FIA Standards 8855-1999 or 8862-2009, or be specifically designed for motor racing. All non-FIA seats are subject to acceptance by the Chief Scrutineer.

**9.4 Harnesses:** All vehicles shall be equipped with a five-, six- or seven-point occupant restraint (harness) system meeting the specifications below for both the driver and co-driver. All harness systems shall be capable of releasing with only one latch. These harnesses shall be worn at all times while driving or co-driving. B. Harnesses shall meet the requirements of one these standards: FIA 8853/98, FIA 8853/2016, SFI 16.1 or SFI 16.5 and shall be labeled accordingly. Harnesses may not be used after their expiration date and shall not be older than 5 years from date of manufacture.

**9.5 Emergency Triangle:** each vehicle will carry 3 emergency triangles. One of which must be located within easy reach of the Driver or Co-Driver when seated.

**9.6 Tow strap:** each competition vehicle must have an appropriate tow strap in the vehicle.

**9.7 Tow points:** each competition vehicle must have front and rear tow points.

**9.8 Fire extinguishers, minimum requirements:** One fire extinguisher with a minimum UL rating of 10 BC or two each with a minimum rating of 5 BC must be installed inside the passenger compartment. One fire extinguisher must be located within easy reach of the driver or co-driver when seated. Extinguisher will be secured using a metal strap and have a fill gauge that is visible for scrutineering. Mounting brackets must be metal.

**9.9 Hood pins:** Hoods shall be fixed closed with hood pins accessible from the outside. Other fastening devices (inside or outside) shall be rendered inoperative, except for the secondary catch, which may be retained.

**10. Supplemental Rules** will be published for each event. The Supps will generally be event specific information.

**11. Tech Inspection:** Vehicle and personal safety equipment must be inspected and approved before any vehicle or person may begin competition. The scrutineering procedure, times and location are described in event Supps.

**12. Required Personal Safety Equipment:** The following items are required for all drivers and co-drivers:

**12.1 Helmets:** All drivers and co-drivers competing must wear helmets that meet one of the following standards:

13.1.1 Snell SA2015, EA2016, SA2020 or SA2025 (SA2015 will expire at the end of the 2026 season)

13.1.2 FIA 8860-2010, FIA 8859-2015, FIA 8860-2018, FIA 8859-2024 (less than 10 years from date of manufacture).

13.1.3 For helmets with dual FIA/SA certification, the later expiration date shall take precedence

**12.2 Head and Neck Restraint Device:** Head and neck restraint systems are required for all competitors. These systems shall be mounted per the manufacturer's recommendations. The head and neck restraint system must meet at least one of the following:

12.2.1 Certified to FIA 8858-2002.

12.2.2. Certified to FIA 8858-2010.

12.2.3. SFI 38.1 licensed. SFI 38.1 licensing requires a SFI 38.1 conformance label that is less than five years old.

If a device has both FIA and SFI certification, the FIA certification prevails and does not expire.

**12.3 Driving suit:** All drivers and co-drivers competing must wear driving suits that conform to one of the following standards:

12.3.1 FIA 8856-2000

12.3.2. FIA 8856-2018

12.3.3 FIA 1986

12.3.4 SFI 3-2A/5

12.3.5 SFI 3-4A/5

12.3.6 SFI 3-2A/1 driving suits are also permitted if worn with approved fire resistant underwear.

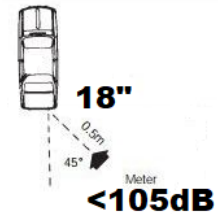
### **13. Vehicles:**

**13.1 Road Legal:** Since public roads will be used for the transits, all competition cars must be registered, inspected if necessary, and insured.

**13.2 Tires:** Appropriate tires are required. DOT Studded tires are allowed for winter events. Homemade studded, bolted, chained, etc, tires not allowed. WRC studded tires may be allowed in exhibition class at winter events only if specified in the event Supps.



**13.3. Noise limit:** Vehicles should not exceed the sound limit set at 105dBa measured at a 45 degree angle and 18" from the tail pipe at 2500rpm. This is the maximum sound permitted at all times (not just at idle) including exhaust pops from antilag. Vehicles who cannot comply with this rule will not be allowed to run. Sound checks may be performed at any point on course. The event has the right at any time to require a competitor to lower the volume created by the vehicle during transit speed to respect the local residents.



**13.4 Lights:** The vehicle must have properly functioning headlights and taillights. All auxiliary lights shall be securely mounted no higher than the top of the hood throwing a beam toward the front of the vehicle.

**14. Car numbers:** Each competitor may choose his/her car number. In the case of duplicate numbers, the first entrant registered will have priority.

**14.1** Car numbers are not supplied by the event and are the responsibility of the entrants.

**14.2** Numbers: Car numbers should be 8" tall and 1.25" brush width minimum.

**15. Timing:** stage timing will be in minutes, seconds, and tenths of seconds.

**16. Special Stages:** There will be two to four distinct stages, run multiple times.

**17. Stage and Transit Notes:**

**17.1** Jemba style stage notes will be provided for the stages and are included in entry fee. They will be prepared by the organizers. These notes are a basis and should not be considered gospel. Teams will be given one recce pass for the purpose of checking and altering the notes as they see fit. Mileages may or may not be included. For those not familiar with Jemba style notes, an internet search of "Jemba stage notes" will return several resources. (P-sport is a good one)

**17.2** Transit notes will be in tulip format. Transits will involve driving on public roads. Obey all speed limits.

**17.3** Stage and transit notes will be in the same book, the "Route Book".

**17.4** Route Books will be handed out at scrutineering.

**17.5** One Route Book will be issued per team.

**18. Recce:** There will be one pass recce for each stage. Recce may be done in the competition car if necessary. Recce will be parade style, with approximately 30 seconds between cars. Max speed during recce is 30 MPH. This is not a practice run. See Supps for any further details.

**19. Service:**

**19.1** General: The service area will be crowded. Please keep your area as compact as possible. Each team has one vehicle width allotted.

**19.2** Ground cover: a tarp should be placed down under the competition vehicle at all times.

**19.3** Trash: This is carry in – carry out. Do not leave garbage around, including cigarette butts.

**19.4** Repairs: Jacking of vehicle:

**19.4.1** Jack stands will be used any time more than one wheel is off the ground during service.

**19.4.2** A jack stand will be used if only one wheel is off the ground and a crew member is under the car.

**19.4.3** Penalty for failing to abide is 5 minutes per offense

**19.5** Service vehicles: Only one service vehicle per team will be allowed in the service area. All other vehicles shall be parked in the parking area behind the office/garage.

## **20. Fueling:**

20.1 Teams should bring enough fuel to run the day. There is no fuel availability on the Team O'Neil site and there is not time to leave to get fuel.

20.2 All fueling will take place in the designated fuel depot area (consistent with stage rally rules).

20.2.1 While fueling, a team member must be at the vehicle being fueled with a fire extinguisher.

20.2.2 Penalty for failing to abide is 5 minutes first offense, disqualification upon second offense.

20.2.3 No smoking cigarettes or any other matter in or within 50 feet of the fuel depot.

**21. Medical:** There will be an Ambulance stationed at the beginning of the stage. The Ambulance must be on site before timed runs begin.

**22. Communication:** official communication for the event will be through a HAM radio network. The Safety Steward, start and finish controls, and sweep will be able to communicate through the net as a minimum. Worker locations along the stage may also be on the net. Radio positions will be indicated by a blue radio sign.

**23. Sweep:** There will be at least one sweep vehicle. In the case of an incident, a sweep vehicle may be dispatched to clear the road. Disabled vehicles will be dealt with as necessary, when time allows.

**24. Competitor meeting:** All drivers and co-drivers will attend the competitor meeting as indicated in the schedule.

**25. Observation Controls:** "O" Controls may be used, generally to check speed during transit. If you encounter a "STOP" sign board during a transit section, you must stop at the control.

## **26. Chicanes and course cones:**

**26.1** There may be chicanes used on the stages. The intent of the chicane is to decrease your speed before a dangerous area of the course, or to keep the overall speed in check. The penalty for hitting chicane features will be 30 seconds per item in the chicane that is displaced. Think of the chicane features as trees....don't hit them.

**26.2 Course cones:** In the wide open slalom and skid pad areas, tall cones will be used to delineate the intended course. Knocking over or displacing these cones will incur a 30 second penalty for each cone hit.

There will usually be a pointer cone in conjunction with a course cone to indicate which side of the course cone to be on.

## **27. Transits:**

**27.1** All transits shall be considered Quiet Zones.

**27.2** There will be NO SPEEDING. Local authorities will be aware of the event and may have radar in use.

### **27.3 Penalties**

**27.3.1** Any team deemed speeding by the O Control worker, in excess of 5 mph above posted limits, will receive a 30 second penalty for each mph beyond 5 above the limit.

**27.3.2** Any team issued a citation for speeding will be immediately removed from competition for the remainder of the event. In the case of an infraction on the final transit, a dnf for the event will be issued.

**28. Event Decals:** There may be event decals supplied at tech. You will be instructed on where to place them. Any decals from rally schools other than Team O'Neil must be removed or covered (The Firm, Dirtfish). Any SCCA decals must be removed or covered.

## **29. Food and beverages:**

**29.1 Food:** Teams should bring their own food for the day. There is no food service on the Team O'Neil site and there is not time to leave to get food. Lunches may be available for purchase through the MotorsportReg site when you register.

**29.2 Beverages:** Teams should bring their own beverages for the day. There is no consumption of alcoholic beverages before or during the Gravel trials.

**30. Spectating:** All persons attending the Gravel trials will follow instructions of the marshals. Team members and crew members have no special viewing privileges and must spectate only in approved areas. All spectators must sign a waiver to enter the property. Anyone under the age of 18 must have a minor waiver completed by parent/guardian.

**31. Lodging:** there are multiple options in Littleton, Whitefield areas. No special deals have been made for the event. Search the web.

**32. Results:** Results will be available online.

**33. Awards:** Awards will be presented to the top team in each competition class as a minimum.

**34. Radio frequencies** for event: May be listed in the event Supps.

**35. Stage stoppage:** If there is a stage stoppage for a red cross situation, road blockage, disabled vehicle, or other reason, the stage will be restarted once the stage has been deemed clear by officials. Vehicles that were stopped or delayed because of an incident may be given a re-run. The vehicle that caused a stoppage will receive a bogey time and no re-run. In the case of a crash, an event official must inspect and clear the vehicle before it may continue competition.



## **Appendices:**

### **A. Incident procedure:**

#### **Appendix A. ON-STAGE EMERGENCY PROCEDURES**

(this procedure is consistent with ARA, CRC and NASA)

1. If a competition vehicle stops on a stage:
  - a. the team must display the OK sign if they are in fact OK to all passing teams. If a team member is injured and needs medical assistance, the RED SOS must be displayed.
  - b. the team must immediately put out triangles. Warning triangles are to be placed on the same side of the road that the vehicle is stopped on. It's expected that triangles will be placed within 30 seconds of knowing the vehicle will not continue. One triangle should be placed at or on the stopped vehicle. A second triangle approximately 150 feet back towards the start of the stage, and the third approximately 300 feet back. Take corners or crests into consideration when placing the triangles. The goal of using triangles is to alert approaching teams of danger; place them so they're visible in advance.
  - c. the team must ensure the vehicle does not prevent the passage of other vehicles.
2. A team that is able to continue on the stage after stopping must remove all warning triangles before continuing on the stage.
3. If an incident has occurred and the team is still in the car, triangles are not displayed and no OK/SOS sign is displayed, the first team to arrive must STOP. The arriving team should evaluate the situation, and if necessary display the SOS and triangles and render assistance to injured competitors.
4. The second team to arrive, seeing a Red SOS, shall stop and get an accurate assessment of the situation and condition of the people, and the location. They should then continue on the stage to the next radio point. This may be a mid-point on the stage, or the stage finish. For this event, on-stage marshals are radio equipped. Information regarding the incident and emergency needs to be given to the radio personnel.
5. Upon notification of the Red Cross situation, the stage will be immediately stopped and medical personnel dispatched from stage start with a radio operator to communicate necessary information.
6. Once the Red SOS is displayed, it must remain displayed. All following competitors must stop and render assistance as needed. Unnecessary teams should then continue to the finish of the stage at transit speed.
7. After the situation has been cleared, the workers at the start control will inform competitors as to how to proceed. At this time, the RED SOS should be removed from the incident scene.
8. The driver of any vehicle involved in a rally related accident resulting in personal injury or property damage must fill-out an Incident Form.
9. If a team has crashed and is not visible from the stage road, or leaves the stage road, and does not require medical assistance, they must still show the OK sign to all passing teams.

Note: An "OK" situation may change to a RED SOS situation. The above procedures are to be followed beginning with the display of the RED SOS sign.